

Chapter 22: Goals

When Lady Feng pushed open Feng Yue's door at nine in the morning, she locked eyes with Feng Yue, who should have still been sleeping in bed but was instead sitting in the living room.

Feng Yue was sitting cross-legged on the living room carpet, surrounded by various stands and ring lights, fiddling with a camera in her hands.

"Mom?" Feng Yue blinked, then stumbled to her feet to clean up the messy living room, coughing awkwardly: "Ahem, why did you come over?"

Her mother had just visited yesterday, so logically she shouldn't be coming today.

Lady Feng stood in the entryway for quite a while, then came to her senses, looking at Feng Yue's chaotic living room with mixed feelings.

"Nuan Nuan, do you really want to live alone?"

Feng Yue awkwardly rubbed her nose: "Today was an accident. I was just unpacking some deliveries."

Lady Feng sighed and resignedly began picking up the delivery boxes and various packaging materials on the floor. After a quick cleanup, she sat down next to Feng Yue: "Did you take your morning medicine?"

Feng Yue nodded obediently.

Lady Feng looked at her obviously pale face from having just vomited, her eyes reddening with heartache.

The first time she witnessed her daughter's reaction after taking medicine, she was heartbroken beyond measure. Her child had never caused them worry since childhood - so well-behaved and beautiful - why did she have to suffer like this?

Seeing her mother's emotional state, Feng Yue immediately put her arm around her shoulders and changed the subject with a smile: "Mom, what delicious food did you bring me? I can already smell it."

Lady Feng blinked, holding back the tears in her eyes, and scolded with a smile: "Nothing gets past your little dog nose¹. You just threw up, right? Come eat something."

Feng Yue smiled and nodded, then went to sit in the dining room with her mother.

"This is soup I made for you according to the nutritionist's medicinal recipe. I've been cooking it since six o'clock. Try it quickly." Lady Feng took out a thermal container from her bag.

"Didn't I say there was no need to hire a nutritionist? I just have some reactions to those medicines. Once this course of treatment is over, it'll be fine." Feng Yue grumbled while continuously drinking the soup.

"What do you know? All medicine has some toxicity². No matter what, we need to take good care of your body." Lady Feng gave her a look. "Besides, I snatched this nutritionist from our neighbor Mrs. Wang. She recently had her second child but won't go to a postpartum center³ - insists on recovering at home."

Feng Yue was shocked: "Ah, she's having a second child at such an advanced age?"

"Exactly, she's already an advanced maternal age mother⁴. It's all because of her husband Mr. Wang, who keeps wanting a son." Lady Feng laughed at this point: "If you ask me, he just doesn't have that fate⁵. This second child turned out to be another daughter. I bet he's furious."

Feng Yue shrugged: "I think girls are great."

"Yes, girls are better. Girls are beautiful and well-behaved, unlike those mischievous boys."

Lady Feng chatted away while Feng Yue listened quietly beside her, occasionally adding a comment.

Watching Lady Feng's bright eyes when talking about these trivial matters, Feng Yue suddenly felt that in her previous life, she had really missed too much because of Yan Lin.

She had missed accompanying her family, missed the friendships she should have had...

Feng Yue sat in her chair, slightly tilting her head up to look at Lady Feng standing beside her. When did it start? Lady Jiang, who had always loved beauty, now had several silver strands at her temples.

"Mom."

"Mm?"

"Next time let's go dye our hair together." Feng Yue kept her head down drinking soup: "I want to change my hair color."

Lady Feng smiled with curved eyes, teasing: "Fine, let's dye our Nuan Nuan's hair green⁶!"

Feng Yue was momentarily stunned, then reacted and laughed: "How do you even know about these internet memes!"

Lady Feng patted her head: "Surprise! Your mom knows how to use the internet too."

"Lady Jiang, amazing!"

After Feng Yue finished the soup her mother brought and they cleaned up the dining table together, she sat back down on the living room carpet.

Lady Feng managed to clear a spot on the sofa where she could sit, then asked: "I wanted to ask you when I came in - what are all these things for?"

Feng Yue rolled her eyes around, put down what she was holding, placed both hands on Lady Feng's knees with her chin resting on her hands, and looked up at her.

"Mom, I want to try making videos."

"Making videos?" Lady Feng was stunned: "What kind of videos?"

Feng Yue straightened up and scooted from the floor to the sofa with one hand supporting her: "My cooking skills have gotten pretty good these past few years, so I'm planning to try making cooking videos."

Lady Feng listened to Feng Yue casually say her cooking skills were pretty good, and her heart ached again. Their Nuan Nuan had never even entered the kitchen until high school graduation, but starting from college, she began learning to cook because of Yan Lin, and had forcibly developed excellent culinary skills.

"That's wonderful! Our Nuan Nuan will do her best at whatever she does!"

"Yay!" Feng Yue happily hugged Lady Feng, then sat back on the carpet: "I knew you'd agree!"

"These things are the tools I need for making videos - this is a tripod, lighting, and most importantly, the camera!" Feng Yue pointed to each item as she introduced them to Lady Feng.

Lady Feng watched Feng Yue's bright smile and couldn't help thinking that this divorce might have truly freed her from the shackles that had bound her.

The old Feng Yue would smile and be happy too, but back then, she was happy because of Yan Lin's happiness and sad because of Yan Lin's sadness. She rarely showed her emotions because of other things.

But now it was different. Her precious daughter had new goals to pursue and wouldn't stay stuck in place.

"No matter what you do, your father and I will always support you."

Feng Yue giggled twice: "Then what about our family business? Should you have another baby?"

"You cheeky girl, making jokes. Even daring to joke about your mom now." Lady Feng laughed and playfully hit her, then continued: "Mom knows you don't like finance and all those company affairs, so don't worry about the family business. Your father can still work, and if he really can't anymore, we'll find a professional manager⁷. You just need to do what you love."

"Mom, I love you to death!" Feng Yue reached out and threw herself into Lady Feng's arms.

"So sweetheart, from now on you can't hide anything from me and your father. We'll always be your support."

"Mm!" Feng Yue buried her head in Lady Feng's embrace, wiping away the tears that hadn't fallen.

The next time Feng Yue and Yan Lin met was on the day they went to the civil affairs bureau to get their divorce certificate.

Yan Lin had just recovered from her serious illness and looked thinner overall, her complexion pale and wan. She had been waiting at the civil affairs bureau entrance early in the morning - she didn't want to keep Feng Yue waiting again.

Mo Yixu was also with Yan Lin. Originally, Yan Lin didn't agree to him coming along, but Lady Yan wouldn't budge on this matter - she was afraid something might happen to Yan Lin on the way.

When Mo Yixu was called to the old mansion early in the morning, he was still somewhat confused. After all, company affairs had been personally handled by the old chairman these past few days, and President Yan hadn't been seen for several days.

Being called to the old mansion today, he thought there was some urgent company matter to handle, but he didn't expect to be asked to accompany the newly recovered President Yan.

Mo Yixu was also shocked when he saw his boss's complexion. After all, their President Yan had always maintained a "Mount Tai could collapse before his eyes without changing expression"⁸ demeanor, but now he rarely saw the word "fragile" written on her face.

At first, he didn't know where such a weak President Yan was going, but as the route gradually became clear, massive waves rose in his heart.

President Yan was going to divorce his wife?!

Mo Yixu followed silently behind Yan Lin until he saw her stop at the civil affairs bureau entrance, finally coming to his senses.

How did President Yan and his wife end up getting divorced?

Mo Yixu had seen Miss Feng many times, and almost every time he was shocked by the look in her eyes when she looked at his boss.

As a young person himself, he naturally knew what kind of amazing love was hidden in those eyes.

So when he learned about their marriage, he only felt a sense of "as expected."

His wife's love and care for President Yan reached a level that even he, an outsider, envied.

But now learning they were getting divorced, he felt somewhat incredulous.

Mo Yixu held his briefcase, suddenly feeling it was quite heavy. This was given to him by Lady Yan before leaving, saying it contained some procedures. And now it seemed it probably contained the documents needed for divorce proceedings.

Yan Lin was dressed very casually today - a houndstooth⁹ suit dress with a dark brown belt, black over-the-knee boots with a slight heel. Her usually meticulously styled black hair was now disheveled with a few strands hanging by her cheeks.

She looked less intimidating than at the company, instead appearing more fragile and... pitiful.

Yan Lin stood silently to one side, head lowered, not knowing what she was thinking. They hadn't arrived particularly early, so couples would occasionally pass by - some happily coming to get married, others coldly coming to sever their emotional ties.

Because of Yan Lin's exceptional appearance, almost everyone looked at her.

Mo Yixu stood nearby feeling quite pressured and tentatively suggested: "President Yan, should we go inside and wait?"

Yan Lin just shook her head lightly, still staring down at her feet.

After a while, Mo Yixu spoke up again: "President Yan—"

Yan Lin frowned. Hadn't she said they wouldn't wait inside? She looked up, about to scold him, when she heard him say:

"Madam has arrived."

Yan Lin turned around to see Feng Yue in a goose-yellow chiffon dress with a light grass-colored knit cardigan over it, her shoulder-length hair half-tied back with the rest hanging over her shoulders.

"A-Yue..."

Feng Yue walked up to Yan Lin, glanced at her, then nodded slightly to Mo Yixu as a greeting.

"Let's go."

Footnotes:

¹ **Little dog nose (小狗鼻子):** An affectionate way to describe someone with a keen sense of smell, like saying they have a "nose like a bloodhound."

² **All medicine has some toxicity (是药三分毒):** A traditional Chinese medicine principle meaning all medications have some side effects or potential harm, emphasizing the need for careful use and proper nutrition to support the body.

³ **Postpartum center (月子中心):** Specialized facilities in Chinese culture where new mothers stay for about a month after giving birth to recover, following traditional "confinement" practices.

⁴ **Advanced maternal age mother (高龄产妇):** In Chinese medical terminology, refers to women who give birth at age 35 or older, considered higher risk pregnancies.

⁵ **Doesn't have that fate (没那个命):** A Chinese expression meaning someone isn't destined to have something, often used regarding having sons versus daughters.

⁶ **Dye hair green:** In Chinese internet slang, "green" often refers to being cheated on (as in "wearing a green hat"), so Lady Feng is playfully making a joke about dyeing Feng Yue's hair an unusual color.

⁷ **Professional manager (职业经理人):** A hired executive to run a company, common in family businesses when the family doesn't want direct involvement.

⁸ **Mount Tai could collapse without changing expression (泰山崩于眼前而不变):** A Chinese idiom describing someone who remains calm and composed even in the face of disaster or extreme circumstances.

⁹ **Houndstooth (千鸟格):** A classic textile pattern of broken checks, literally "thousand bird pattern" in Chinese, commonly used in professional attire.